

STARTER

Field-by-Field Online Application Walkthrough

Australia - Visitor Visa (Subclass 600, Tourist stream)

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

Before you start

The Visitor visa (subclass 600), Tourist stream, is applied for online through an ImmiAccount at the Department of Home Affairs. It's decided under the Migration Act 1958 and Migration Regulations 1994 by a departmental case officer. Gather the following before you begin:

- Valid passport or other travel document
- Details of your trip: purpose, planned dates, and where you'll stay
- Evidence of your ties to your home country: employment, family, property, or ongoing study
- Financial evidence covering your trip - see the Financial Requirements Overview (Essential tier)
- Health and character information - you may be asked for a police certificate or a medical examination depending on your circumstances, nationality, and intended length of stay

A FULLY ELECTRONIC VISA - NO PASSPORT STICKER

Australia doesn't put a visa label (vignette) in your passport. Your visa exists electronically, linked to your passport number in the department's system. There's nothing to collect or stick in - once granted, you can check your visa conditions and validity through your ImmiAccount or the VEVO (Visa Entitlement Verification Online) service, and airlines and border officials check it electronically too.

Section-by-section

1. Personal details

Name, date of birth, nationality, and passport details exactly as they appear in your passport. Declare any other nationalities or passports you hold.

2. Details of your visit

- Purpose of travel (tourism, visiting family/friends) and your intended stream - this guide covers the Tourist stream; a separate Business Visitor stream exists for short business activities
- Planned entry and exit dates, and where you'll stay

3. The Genuine Temporary Entrant (GTE) requirement

Australia requires you to satisfy the case officer that you're a genuine temporary entrant - a named, formal criterion applied across many Australian temporary visas, not just an informal impression. It considers your circumstances in your home country, your circumstances in Australia, the strength of your ties to both, and the genuineness of your stated intentions. This is Australia's specific version of the "ties to home country" or "genuine visitor" concept used elsewhere.

4. Family information

Details of your spouse/partner and children, and whether any are travelling with you or already in Australia.

5. Health and character

Standard declarations covering criminal history and health conditions. Depending on your nationality, intended stay length, and personal circumstances, you may be directed to complete a health examination or provide a police certificate as part of your application - the department will tell you if this applies to you.

6. Pay the visa application charge

The Visa Application Charge (VAC) is paid online as part of submission and is generally non-refundable, whether or not your visa is granted.

7. Submit supporting documents

Upload your financial evidence, ties-to-home documents, and any invitation from someone in Australia. The department may request additional information if something in your file needs clarifying - respond by the stated deadline if this happens.